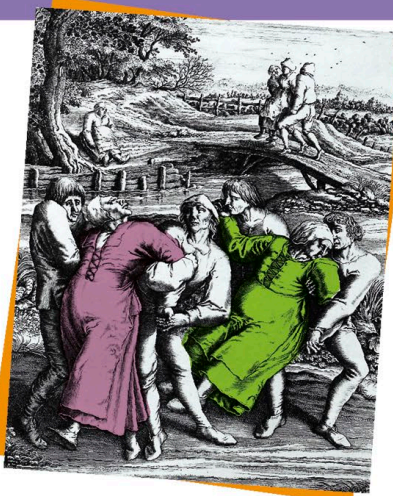


June

24



1374

Dance mania

Thousands of people in Aachen, Germany, started dancing uncontrollably in a bout of dancing mania. The reasons for this phenomenon are not known, though illness, religious devotion, and poisonous fungi have all been suggested.

Born this day

1987 Lionel Messi, Argentinian football player. He joined Barcelona FC as a teenager, and eventually became their top player. A famous dribbler of the ball, he scored more than 1,200 goals in his career, and won the prestigious *Ballon d'Or* award six times.

2010 An epic match

The longest tennis match on record began at Wimbledon, UK, between the USA's John Isner (below left) and Nicolas Mahut (below centre) from France. After an exhausting 11 hours and 5 minutes of play over three days, Isner finally won the fifth set and the match.



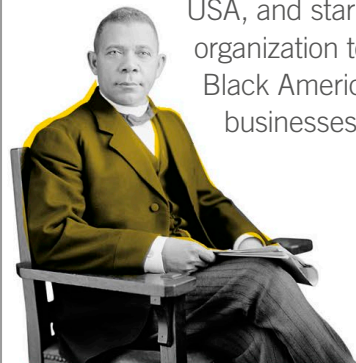
1896

Honorary degree

Educator Booker T Washington became the first Black American to receive an honorary degree from Harvard University in the USA.

Washington founded what is now Tuskegee University in Alabama,

USA, and started an organization to support Black American businesses.



Also on this day

2012 The last Pinta Island giant tortoise, named Lonesome George, died aged 102. His species, which lived on the Galápagos Islands of Ecuador, died out because of hunting.

2017 Female footballers from many countries played a match in a crater on Mount Kilimanjaro, Tanzania, at an altitude of 5,714 m (18,746 ft). It is the highest-altitude football match on record.